

Silvia Téliz

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Summary

I am a PhD candidate (expected July 2027) at the Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania, studying how social identity is visually conveyed and leveraged in political communication. I combine computer vision, natural language processing, and machine learning to analyze large-scale text, image, and video data — from out-of-home political advertisements in Mexican elections to political expression on TikTok — and to study bias in AI systems such as vision-language models.

Education

Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania , PhD in Communication – Philadelphia, PA, USA Degree expected in July 2027.	July 2027
Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania , Master of Arts in Communication – Philadelphia, PA, USA	May 2024
Universidad Panamericana , Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Mexico City, Mexico	May 2018

Technical Skills and Methodologies

Languages: Spanish: native speaker, English: advanced (C2), French: intermediate (B2), German: intermediate (B1)

Methods: Computational visual analysis, natural language processing, machine learning, social media data collection, survey and experiment design, content analysis

Programming: Python, R, Git, HTML, CSS

Software: Gephi, Adobe Illustrator, GitHub, Stata

AI Tools and Deployment: Hugging Face Transformers, Ollama, OpenRouter, proprietary LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI, Gemini), PyTorch

Relevant Experience

Politics, Identities, and Communication Lab – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania May 2025 – present

Research Fellow

- Secured \$10,000 USD via the Annenberg School for Communication Internal Grant for the project ‘Identifying Biases in VLMs’ Zero-Shot Classifications of Race and Gender’ (2026-2027 academic year), as principal investigator.
- Co-authored ‘WhichTok? Comparing Three TikTok Data Acquisition Tools’ (Jeon et al., 2026, preprint), contributing to theoretical conceptualization, writing, reviewing, and editing.
- Ongoing project: ‘Aligned identities, curated politics: Mapping political expression on TikTok across the ideological spectrum’, contributing to theoretical conceptualization, formulation of overarching research goals, methodology design, computational visual analysis of over 5000 TikTok videos, writing, reviewing, and editing.
- Ongoing project: ‘What do engagement metrics measure? Strategic optimization and content characteristics in AI-related content on TikTok’, contributing to theoretical conceptualization, formulation of overarching research goals, methodology design, computational visual analysis of over 2000 TikTok videos, writing, reviewing, and editing.

Introduction to Communication Behavior – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Jan 2026 – May 2026

Teaching Fellow

- Provided individual assistance and clarification during dedicated office hours.

- Assisted the instructor with logistical tasks, such as managing the online learning platform and maintaining grade and attendance records.
- Graded and provided dedicated feedback for assignments and final papers.

Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

Research Fellow

- Worked under Dr. Juan Llamas Rodríguez's supervision on the development of a mixed-methods study on the representation of gender and skin color stereotypes in Mexican telenovelas and TV series (a report commissioned by the Luminate foundation).
- Co-authored 'Poder Prieto: Media, Colorism, and Cultural Activism in Mexico' (Llamas-Rodríguez and Téliz Martínez, 2026, in press), contributing to theoretical conceptualization, formulation of overarching research goals, writing, reviewing, and editing.

Children and Media – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

Teaching Fellow

- Provided individual assistance and clarification during dedicated office hours.
- Assisted the instructor with logistical tasks, such as managing the online learning platform and maintaining grade and attendance records.
- Graded and provided dedicated feedback for assignments and final papers.
- Assisted in designing and grading exams.
- Taught lecture on racial representations in children's media.

DragonLab Consultants – Mexico City, Mexico 2021 – 2022

Researcher

- Participated in the research consulting project titled 'Analysis of Court Rulings with Gender Perspective'.
- Analyzed and coded the content of 342 court rulings to determine if Mexican judges use gender perspective adequately.
- Performed the statistical exploration of the data sets obtained from said content analysis.
- Synthesized the results from the content analysis into a report that Mexico's Judiciary will use to evaluate the nation's Protocol to Judge with Gender Perspective.

Quantitative Methods for Communication Research – Universidad Panamericana, Mexico City Jan 2020 – Dec 2022

Instructor of Record

- Served as the Instructor of Record for an undergraduate-level course, delivering all lectures and directing all class activities for the Communication major.
- Introduced the programming language R into the curriculum as the main tool for learning Quantitative Methods.
- Designed all educational materials, including original slides, assignments, tests, and lab activities.
- Held regular office hours for student assistance and managed the grading of all assignments, including weekly lab activities and final projects.

Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales (FLACSO) – Mexico City, Mexico 2018 – 2022

Research Assistant

- Analyzed data and designed visualizations for a research project about the gap between political and economic globalization.
- Coordinated a research consulting project to identify the strengths and weaknesses of the evaluation system of information transparency for the National Institute of Access to Information and Personal Data Protection.
- Developed an academic program and created didactic content for the National School for Women of the Institutional Revolutionary Party, empowering female members through education on gender perspective, political representation, and communication strategies.
- Created educational content for the Migrant-e project (led by the Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México), teaching undocumented immigrants in the United States about their rights and safety tools.

Publications

- WhichTok? Comparing Three TikTok Data Acquisition Tools** Aug 2026
Gayoung Jeon, Cameron Moy, Silvia Téliz, Cristina Monzer, Nicolette Alayon, Deen Freelon
arxiv.org/abs/2608.09917 (arXiv preprint)
- Poder Prieto: Media, Colorism, and Cultural Activism in Mexico** July 2026
Juan Llamas-Rodríguez, Silvia Téliz Martínez
nyupress.org/9781479835164/planet-digital (Planet Digital, NYU Press)
- Agresiones a periodistas y cobertura mediática de la corrupción** 2021
Georgina Flores-Ivich, Silvia Téliz Martínez
[10.2307/j.ctv1jhvn9w](https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctv1jhvn9w) (Crisis de estatalidad y violaciones a derechos humanos, FLACSO México)

Presentations

- Mechanisms of Social Bias in Large Language Models: Disentangling Linguistic Framing from Group Specification** July 2026
Vishwanath Emani Venkata, Silvia Téliz
IC2S2 conference - Burlington, VT, USA - conference presentation
- Picturing Immigration: A Multimodal Computational Analysis of the 2024 U.S. Presidential Campaign** August 2025
Silvia Téliz, Gayoung Jeon
PolNet-PACSS conference - Boston, MA, USA - poster presentation
- A Picture is Worth a Thousand Fictions: Visual Political Communication in the Age of Generative AI** April 2025
Silvia Téliz
CIND Workshop 2025 - Philadelphia, PA, USA - invited talk
- Hues of Victory: Using Computer Vision to Examine Skin Color's Influence on Electoral Success** June 2024
Silvia Téliz
ICA Preconference: "A Computational Turn in Journalism: Opportunities and Challenges in a Cross-Disciplinary Field" - Singapore - conference presentation
- Status, Color and Race: Dissecting the content of Latin American class stereotypes** May 2023
Valentina Proust Iligaray, Silvia Téliz
ICA Preconference: "Media and Communication in Global Latinidades" - Online - conference presentation

Honors and Awards

- Annenberg School for Communication Internal Grant** 2026
\$10,000 USD, principal investigator, for the project 'Identifying Biases in VLMs' Zero-Shot Classifications of Race and Gender' (2026-2027 academic year).
- Graduate Scholarship in Sciences and Humanities** 2025
Awarded by the Ministry of Science, Humanities, Technology and Innovation of Mexico (SECIHTI)
- Fulbright García-Robles Scholarship** 2022
Awarded by the US-Mexico Foundation (COMEXUS)

Certificates

- Summer Institute in Computational Social Science** June 2026
Awarded by the University of Pennsylvania
- Certificate in College and University Teaching** 2025

Awarded by the University of Pennsylvania

Scholarly Memberships and Service

Center for Information Networks and Democracy – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Doctoral fellow and meeting administrator	2023 – present
Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Doctoral fellow	2022 – present
Graduate Student Council – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Member and information manager	2023 – 2024